



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-170
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 14, 2026

MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR ZUSY

- WHEREAS: This Policy Order serves as a brief of the process to hire the City Clerk position to date; and
- WHEREAS: This process began in the 2024-2025 City Council term, following the retirement of Clerk Diane P. LeBlanc, and the appointment of Paula M. Crane as Interim City Clerk, effective June 1, 2025; and
- WHEREAS: On June 30, 2025, the Council voted [to establish a preliminary screening committee and formally begin a search for a permanent City Clerk](#); and
- WHEREAS: The 2025 City Clerk Preliminary Screening Committee met on several occasions and held a series of first and second round interviews in Executive Session; and
- WHEREAS: After completing these interviews, the Committee was unable to identify two finalist candidates to go before the full Council for a final interview; and
- WHEREAS: As a result, the process was suspended at the end of the term, and [Paula M. Crane's appointment as Interim City Clerk was extended for an additional six months](#), as detailed in a [communication from then-Mayor Simmons to the Council](#); and
- WHEREAS: [On January 22, 2026, Mayor Siddiqui appointed the 2026 City Clerk Preliminary Screening Committee](#), which again met over several months to review applicants, conduct interviews, and work with the city's Human Resources department to recruit a strong pool of finalists to present to the Council; and
- WHEREAS: Despite these efforts, several highly qualified applicants withdrew from consideration, and the process was again suspended; and
- WHEREAS: [On May 18, 2026, Paula M. Crane's Interim appointment](#) was extended once more to allow the Committee time to evaluate next steps; and
- WHEREAS: On July 28, 2026, the Preliminary Screening Committee met to discuss the process to date and next steps, including reposting the position; and
- WHEREAS: Following this discussion, Mayor Siddiqui was informed that Paula M. Crane was now interested in the position after not applying previously; and

- WHEREAS: The Sponsors of this Order, who also served as members of the Preliminary Screening Committee, have determined that appointing Paula M. Crane as City Clerk is the most effective and appropriate course of action; now therefore be it
- ORDERED: That the City Council appoint Paula Crane to the office of City Clerk; and be it further
- ORDERED: That the City Solicitor engage the services of a suitable law firm, in consultation with the City's Chief People Officer and with approval of the City Solicitor, to negotiate an employment contract with Paula M. Crane on behalf of the City Council, and be it further
- ORDERED: That the full City Council discuss the terms of the employment contract in a future Executive Session, with final approval of terms and appointment to occur at a subsequent future open meeting of the City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-



Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

That the City Solicitor engage the services of a suitable law firm, in consultation with the City's Chief People Officer and with approval of the City Solicitor, to negotiate an employment contract with Paula M. Crane on behalf of the City Council.